Ishkhan Khchoian

Operations / Process Improvement Coordinator

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PROFILE

Operations coordinator with over six years of experience running operations and projects across different business areas — construction and retail, client services for U.S. companies, live events and an AI startup. Most of my results come from the process side: finding where a team loses time, writing the standard that fixes it, and training people until it becomes the normal way of working.

I am currently COO of SayWhen.am, an AI voice-agent startup, where I run development with the CTO and manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle. I completed a project management course through a U.S. Embassy program and learn an operation from the floor up before changing it — that is why the changes stick.

WHY ME FOR THIS ROLE

- **Process redesign with measurable results.** As a case manager at U.S. legal services companies I rebuilt client-project workflows. At one company the cycle became strictly six months or less, two- and four-month express tracks were introduced, errors decreased, and the share of successful cases rose by 35%.
- **Delivery against fixed deadlines.** In a family construction business I managed an investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M; every site was delivered on time and accepted with no defects noted.
- **Standards that stick.** My templates, checklists and hand-off rules became the team's default way of working, and the internal training program I built went on to serve 50+ people.
- **Bottleneck first, then the fix.** I map where work waits — for a person, a tool, a part or a decision — before proposing anything, and I make the fix measurable so it can be checked rather than argued about.
- **Physical operations, not just paperwork.** Construction and retail sites with teams of 2–20: contractors, procurement, transport and tenders. Live events for up to 3,000 people: vendors, logistics, scheduling and day-of operations.
- **Work you can see.** I run work on visible boards — Kanban for the flow and Gantt charts for the schedule — so everyone knows what is next without asking.

SKILLS

- **Operations:** scheduling and capacity planning · workflow mapping and bottleneck analysis · SOPs, checklists and work instructions · KPI tracking and reporting · procurement, supplies and vendor coordination · quality checks and acceptance criteria
- **People:** hiring, onboarding and training programs · crew coordination, teams of up to 20 · daily stand-ups · cross-functional communication · escalation handling
- **Methods & tools:** Kanban · Gantt · Lean basics (5S, standard work, visual management) · Scrum · Excel / Google Sheets · 1C · Jira · Confluence · Trello · Monday · Notion · Bitrix24 · MS Office · Google Workspace

EXPERIENCE

COO — SayWhen.am (AI voice-agent startup) Feb 2026 – present

- Run product development with the CTO in Jira and Confluence: requirements, specification, backlog and priorities, and acceptance of each stage.
- Manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle: needs discovery, agreement on scope and timelines, and regular progress reporting during implementation.

Freelance — project and legal work Feb 2026 – present

- Designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy): a three-scenario funnel model, budget, payback and decision gates.
- Business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); legal projects — IP assignment for works by popular musicians, a corporate structure for a crypto trader and advice on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia; sale of family real estate.

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation (U.S.) Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned up to **12 complex client projects at a time**, end to end, against fixed external deadlines.
- Redesigned the delivery process: a cycle of **strictly six months or less**, new **two- and four-month express tracks**, fewer errors through a shared knowledge base, and a **35% higher success rate**.
- Coordinated **8 specialists** and reviewed their work against written acceptance criteria; my templates, checklists and hand-off rules became the team standard.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Delivered live events for **100 to 3,000** people — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip; owned vendors, logistics, scheduling and day-of operations.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through.

Legal practice — U.S. law firms, Arbitration Court, Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2024

- Senior Paralegal at Shamayev Business Law, Paralegal at Bloomrich Law Firm: built the internal training program **Paralegal Academy** (50+ people) and improved the firms' internal processes.
- Judge's Associate: **200+ concurrent cases, 30+ hearings a week**; earlier, contract analysis and claims work at a Bar Association.

Project Manager — SIS LLC (family business) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- Managed projects including an **investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M** — every site delivered **on time and accepted with no defects noted**.
- Teams of up to 20; procurement, logistics between sites and recruiting; built the first schedules and Gantt charts; set up a regional supply network for the retail business.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Professional Scrum Master I (Scrum.org)** — exam scheduled for November 2026.
- **Project Management (PM Club)** — 2023, 52 hours.
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection and completed it alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.

ALSO

- **2nd place, HackNation** local pitches, final at TUMO Labs (July 2026); **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organizing team, led a crew of 12; performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; aid to ~100 families a day.